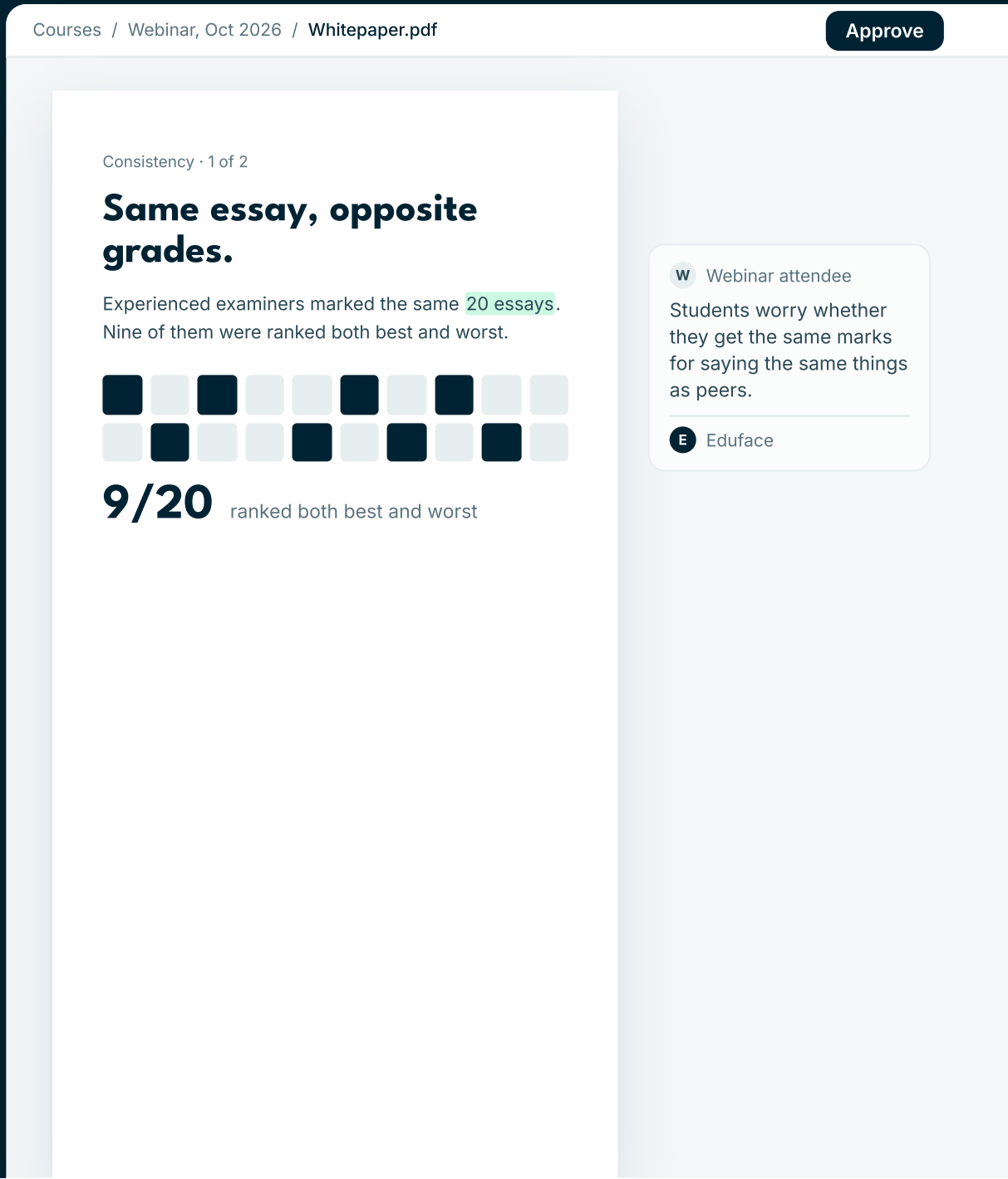
Whitepaper · October 2026

The business outcomes of AI marking and feedback

Consistency and operational efficiency, from 20+ implementations.

Eduface



Two outcomes

Consistency

Students are judged on their work, not on who marked it.

9/20

essays ranked both best and worst

Every paper is marked against the same criteria in the same way, whoever marks it.

- Same mark
- Same focus
- Same style

Operational efficiency

Lecturer time moves from typing feedback to teaching.

−85%

time spent typing feedback

Less staff time per assignment for the same or better feedback, while the lecturer still approves every comment and every mark.

- Less typing
- Lecturer approves
- More teaching

Consistency · 1 of 2

Eduface

Same essay, opposite grades

24 experienced examiners · 20 UK universities · the same 20 essays



9 of 20 essays were ranked among both the best and the worst.

Many markers, one module
Each marker reads the rubric a little differently.

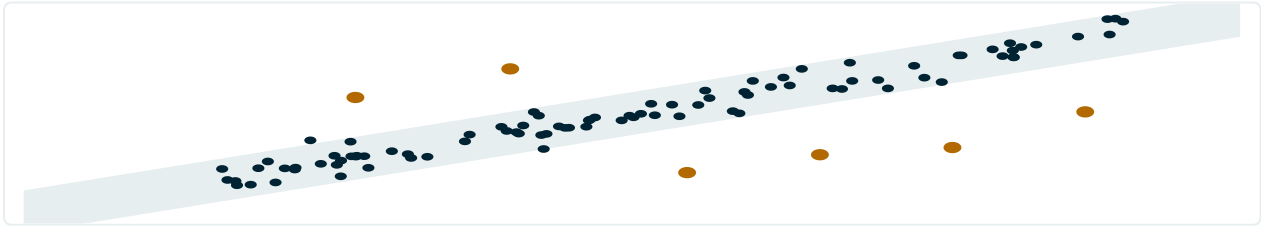
Paper 80 is not paper 5
The same marker marks the eightieth paper differently from the fifth.

Moderation sees a sample
The other papers are never compared.

Consistency overview Beta

Module EDU201 · Essay 2

Each dot is one paper. The band is the expected range for that paper. **6 papers** fall outside it.



W Webinar attendee

Students worry whether they get the same marks for saying the same things as peers who were marked by someone else.

E Eduface

This is consistency as students feel it.

W Webinar attendee

Why should complete consistency be the ideal in an activity that relies on expert judgement?

E Eduface

It shouldn't be. Consistency means the same criteria are applied. Markers can still disagree, and the consistency overview shows where they do.

↓ Consistency overview

Bloxham et al., Assessment & Evaluation in Higher Education, 2016. Consistency overview: illustrative screen, fictional data, in beta.

Consistency · 2 of 2 Beta

Eduface

No AI grade shown

Not ready for AI grades? The consistency check reads every paper in the background and flags marks outside the expected range.

Essay 2 · Module EDU201 Your marking

Submission	Your mark	AI grade	Consistency signal
#1042	65	Hidden	–
#1043	58	Hidden	–
#1044	72	Hidden	–
#1045	41	Hidden	Outside expected range
#1046	67	Hidden	–

A spreadsheet compares marks with marks.
A 41 looks low next to a 65. It can't tell if the paper deserved it.

The check compares the mark with the paper.
A 41 on a weak paper stays quiet. A 41 on a strong paper gets flagged.

E Eduface · how the check works

1. It analyses every submission in the background, while the marker marks as usual.

E Eduface · how the check works

2. It only raises a signal when a mark falls outside the expected range for that paper.

E Eduface · how the check works

3. It never shows an AI grade, never changes a mark and makes no decision. It can add comments, if you want them.

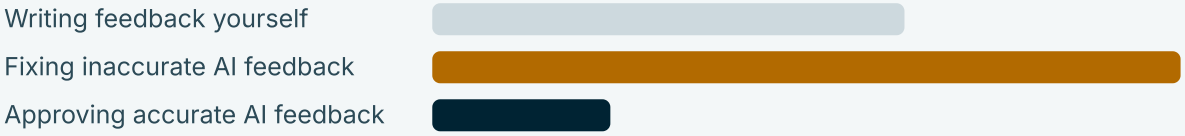
Illustrative screen, fictional data. The consistency check is in beta and not yet generally available.

Operational efficiency · 1 of 2

Eduface

Accuracy saves the time

Time per assignment



Illustration, not a measurement.

Your rubric and instructions + The model follows them = Feedback you would give → **Approve, don't rewrite**

94%

average accuracy, 435 submissions and 13 markers

98%

for markers who tuned the model to their rubric

−85%

time spent typing feedback, up to 20 min per assignment

W Webinar attendee

Could or should we trust the statistical probability of an AI model?

E Eduface

Not blindly. Measure it against your own markers first. That is what these numbers are.

Accuracy is how close the AI's grade proposal is to the marker's own grade, on average. It is not a match rate. Accuracy measured in one of our implementations, typing time across our implementations.

Operational efficiency · 2 of 2

Eduface

The lecturer decides

AI drafts
a comment per rubric criterion

→

Lecturer decides
approves, edits or adds

→

Student receives
only approved feedback

97% of summative assignments get extra feedback from the lecturer, on top of the AI draft. Lecturers don't outsource their judgement.

A nudge against rubber-stamping



After a long run of drafts approved untouched, the platform asks the lecturer a question about one specific assignment.

Eduface

Students only ever see feedback their lecturer approved.

Edit rate: Eduface implementations.

Next step

Eduface

Start small

Jisc's advice to institutions starting with AI in assessment: begin small, with a pilot. It matches what we have learned across 20+ implementations.

Phase 1
A small group
A few lecturers, one module, one use case. The model is tuned to their rubric.

Phase 2
Proven use cases
What worked moves to more modules and more markers.

Phase 3
Gradual roll-out
The next use cases are added one at a time, when the institution is ready.

Where institutions often start

The consistency check on a module that is already marked Beta

AI-drafted formative feedback on one assignment

> **We have experience starting small and deliberately with a smaller group, and rolling out the use cases an institution wants step by step.**

W Webinar attendee
I'm sure there is something to investigate here, but it's not straightforward.

E Eduface
Agreed. That is why we start small.